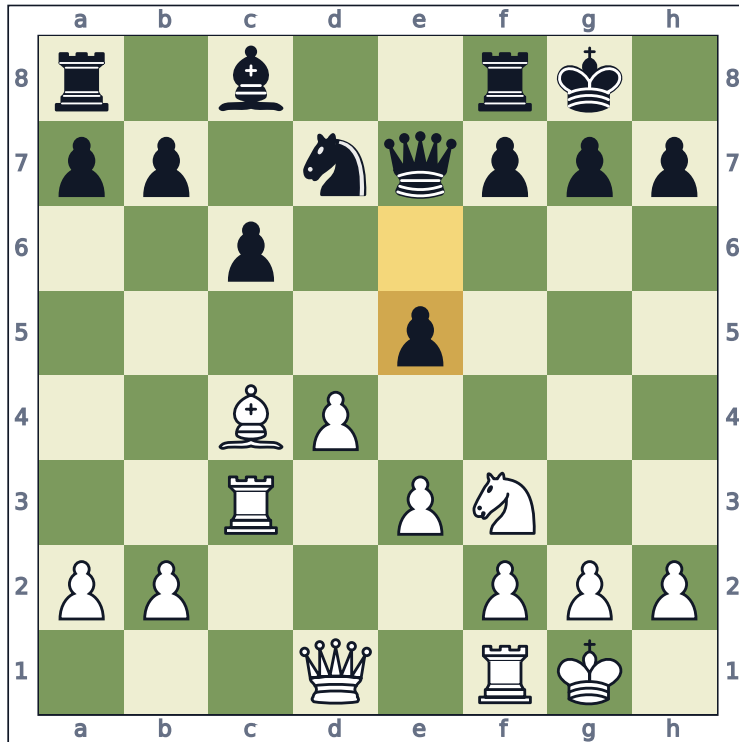


QUEEN'S GAMBIT STRUCTURES

Queen's Gambit Declined

ECO D68 | 3 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.43 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Sharp and concrete: initiative, development, and king safety outweigh routine positional rules.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

D68 covers Queen's Gambit Declined. White uses c4 to challenge Black's d5 pawn and seeks lasting central or queenside pressure. The diagram uses the featured line Queen's Gambit Declined: Orthodox Defense, Classical Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bg5 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Nf3 Nbd7 7. Rc1 c6 8. Bd3 dxc4 9. Bxc4 Nd5 10. Bxe7 Qxe7 11. O-O Nxc3 12. Rxc3 e5

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Recover or transform the c-pawn investment, complete development, and choose between a central break and minority play.

BLACK'S GOALS

Maintain a sound d5 point, free the c8 bishop, and seek ...c5 or ...e5 before passivity sets in.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

Black's ...c5 and ...e5 are freeing breaks; White commonly uses e4, cxd5, or b4-b5 in minority structures.

PIECE MAP

The c-file, d-file, and minority-attack squares matter. Bishops often improve after central exchanges. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Holding an extra c4 pawn can cost too much development; returning it at the right moment is often best. A gambit is a tactical contract: the sacrificed material must buy concrete time, lines, or targets.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. Material is level. Central markers: Black pawn on c6, White pawn on d4, White pawn on e3, Black pawn on e5.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

One of chess's most reliable and educational opening complexes, sound at every level.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named D68 line

This section preserves all 3 names and defining routes assigned to D68 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Queen's Gambit Declined: Orthodox Defense, Classical Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bg5 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Nf3 Nbd7 7. Rc1 c6 8. Bd3 dxc4 9. Bxc4 Nd5 10. Bxe7 Qxe7 11. O-O Nxc3 12. Rxc3 e5

002 Queen's Gambit Declined: Orthodox Defense, Classical Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 Be7 5. Bg5 O-O 6. e3 Nbd7 7. Rc1 c6 8. Bd3 dxc4 9. Bxc4 Nd5 10. Bxe7 Qxe7 11. O-O Nxc3 12. Rxc3 e5 13. Qc2

003 Queen's Gambit Declined: Orthodox Defense, Classical Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 Be7 5. Bg5 O-O 6. e3 Nbd7 7. Rc1 c6 8. Bd3 dxc4 9. Bxc4 Nd5 10. Bxe7 Qxe7 11. O-O Nxc3 12. Rxc3 e5 13. Qb1